

Reliance on Fossil Fuels: A Barrier in Achieving Climate Action (SDG 13)

Introduction (30 seconds)

Imagine a child born today in a coastal area that's already seeing the effects of climate change. In just a few decades, their home may be underwater because of rising sea levels. The burning of fossil fuels is causing this, and it's a problem that is growing every day. The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC, 2021) warns that sea levels could rise by up to 1 meter by the year 2100, threatening millions of lives.

Real-Life Impact (1 minute)

Think about the parents of these children. Many of them rely on fishing or farming, which are already being affected by climate change. In places like Bangladesh, saltwater is flooding farmlands, making it impossible to grow crops. As a result, families are being forced to leave their homes and their communities. The United Nations reports that climate refugees are increasing, with many losing everything to rising seas and natural disasters (UNHCR, 2023).

The Moral Dilemma (1 minute)

Continuing to burn fossil fuels means that we are making decisions today that will harm these families tomorrow. The emissions we produce now are making it harder for future generations to survive. This isn't just about the environment—it's about people. These families are losing their homes, their cultures, and their hope for the future. It's our responsibility to make changes now so that these children can have a safe, stable life.

Conclusion (30 seconds)

We must stop relying on fossil fuels and switch to cleaner, renewable energy sources. Every action we take today can help protect these families. Climate change isn't just a global issue—it's a human issue. We have the power to make a difference. Thank you.

References:

Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC). (2021). *Climate change 2021: The physical science basis*. <https://www.ipcc.ch/report/ar6/wg1/>

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR). (2023). *Climate change and displacement*. <https://www.unhcr.org/climate-change-and-displacement.html>